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Sungrow - A

FCC targets new Chinese inverter imports; maintain OW as negative already priced in

On July 28th, the FCC said it would block imports of new Chinese humanoid/quadruped robots and connected power inverters. While this is not entirely new, the scope (covering both inverter and ESS PCS products and both utility-scale and off-grid applications) trends towards the bearish side. In-line with market expectations, the ban would affect new models, where previously FCC approved models can still be sold to the U.S. We see negative earnings implications to be more mid-term. Another key development will be the legal interpretation on “remote connectivity”. Per Sungrow, its products do not have wireless communication capability and are connected to its customer control unit via a physical cable. Potentially, Sungrow could apply for a conditional approval to secure FCC authorizations for new models through an individualized risk assessment (via DoW/DHS) but the hurdles could be high, in our view.

We estimate the U.S. was ~20–25% of Sungrow’s 2025 gross profit; a full U.S. exit could imply ~20–25% earnings downside (assuming Sungrow will rationalize its operations). After ~25% underperformance vs. SHCOMP since Jun30th, Sungrow trades at ~12x FY27E P/E (or ~15x excluding U.S. exposure) and a 26/27 ex-US ESS installation CAGR of ~40%, we see valuation as compensating for the risk and maintain OW. That said, this development also caps Sungrow’s re-rating potential from the AIDC ESS theme. Within China ESS integrators, we also flag Deye as a cleaner EM DG ESS growth exposure.

- **Event summary:** On July 28th, the Federal Communications Commission (FCC) released that they would block imports of new Chinese humanoid and quadruped robots, as well as connected power inverters, which are devices that allow renewable energy sources and batteries to connect to the grid and to data center equipment ([link](#)).
- **Our analysis and conclusion:** This is not entirely new to the market, as news reports have suggested a possible FCC rule being considered that could restrict new foreign inverter imports to the US on June 30th ([link](#) to our report). That said, the scope (covering both inverter and ESS PCS, both grid-scale and behind-the meter applications) is coming in towards the more stringent side of things and we take this as a negative (though not entirely unexpected outcome). Having said that, there are still elements pending further legal interpretation, which we summarize in the following table. An important element is whether “remote connectivity” is defined broadly enough to capture its new inverter models; if so, those models may no longer be sold in the U.S. We believe existing, already-authorized models are likely unaffected for now, which would push any earnings impact out by a few years.

Overweight

300274.SZ, 300274.CH

Price (28 Jul 26): Rmb112.08

Price Target (Dec-26): Rmb212.00

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Table 1: Key aspects of this ruling, JPM remarks and impact to Sungrow's earnings

Key aspect of this ruling	Probability/JPM remarks	Timing on the Impacts on earnings
Remote connectivity for power inverters	JPM view: In the FCC's definition, the restriction applies to power inverters which have remote connectivity function, while Sungrow argues that its products does not have such function (i.e. wifi and bluetooth). We note that Sungrow is discussing this issue with US lawyers, and it may depends on FCC's final explanation.	If the FCC deems that Sungrow's products fall in this category, Sungrow's new inverter models may not be sold in the US anymore. Else, Sungrow can continue selling its products, the best possible case.
FCC's authorization for existing products	JPM view: Per the FCC, this ruling should not prohibit the import, sale, or use of any existing models. We believe there is a high probability that Sungrow may still be able to sell its old models for a few years.	The actual earnings impacts may be in a few years.
Product type: Does this ruling apply to PCS/ESS inverter?	JPM view: Per the FCC's definition, we believe there is a high probability that PCS/ESS inverters shall be included in the list (impacted by the FCC ruling). This is towards the bearish side of market discussion.	
Application: Does this ruling apply to BTM/grid-scale inverter?	JPM view: Per the FCC's definition, we believe there is a high probability that BTM/grid-scale inverters shall be included in the list (impacted by the FCC ruling). This is a little worse than what some investors have hoped for.	

Source: FCC, J. P. Morgan estimates.

- How to apply for exemption:** Per the FCC, there is a potential that the Department of War (DoW) or the Department of Homeland Security (DHS) may grant "Conditional Approval". Inverter manufacturers may seek conditional approval through an individualized risk assessment, while DoW/DHS may request more information. Note that applications must be submitted by 1st Jan 2028, with the required information including (1) corporate structure, i.e. legal name, jurisdiction of incorporation, ownership structure, board members and executive leadership, etc.; (2) manufacturing and supply chain disclosure, i.e. bill of materials, country of origin of every component, etc.; (3) US manufacturing and onshoring plan, i.e. a detailed, time-bound plan to establish US manufacturing so the device can qualify for FCC authorization, etc.
- Stock calls and our recommendation:** We believe US markets should make up 20-25% of Sungrow's gross profit in 2025. If we assume Sungrow is completely cut out of the US market, we see risk of a ~20% to 25% earnings cut (assuming Sungrow to rationalize its cost base), but set this against a 40% 2026-27CAGR TAM growth (ex-US) for its ESS business. Currently, Sungrow is trading at 12x FY27E P/E, or 15x FY27E P/E if excluding US exposure. We think the current valuation justifies the risk and maintain our OW. That said, room for re-rating for AIDC ESS theme is now rather limited. On a separate note, within China ESS integrators, we think Deye (605117 CH, OW) is a cleaner story on EM (emerging market) DG (distributed generation) ESS growth.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

Sungrow - A (Overweight; Price Target: Rmb212.00)

Investment Thesis

Sungrow is the world's largest solar inverter producer (by production volume), with a market share of ~30% as of FY24. Sungrow has gained market share in recent years because of its cost advantage. Relative to other domestic producers, Sungrow has superior product quality and more established brand awareness, in our view. We rate Sungrow OW as we expect it to ride on strong ESS demand, on the back of rising order potential from both utilities and data centers.

Valuation

Our Dec-26 PT of Rmb212 equates to a 12-month forward target P/E of 23.0x. We use SOTP valuations for its different segments. Our target multiple is -0.1 stdev vs. the historical average.

SOTP valuation	Method	Fwd 1yr multiple	FY26E PT (Rmb)
EPC	P/E	23.0x	13.4
Inverter	P/E	23.0x	60.6
ESS	P/E	23.0x	115.0
Others	P/E	23.0x	22.6
Total (round)			212.0

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Downside risks to our rating and price target include: lower-than-expected solar/ESS installation growth; worse-than-expected pricing and GPM profile; and worse-than-expected competition from domestic players.

Upside risks include: higher-than-expected solar/ESS installation growth; better-than-expected pricing and GPM profile; and better-than-expected competition from domestic players.

Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 29 July 2026, unless otherwise indicated)
Deye - A(605117.SS/Rmb85.13/OW)

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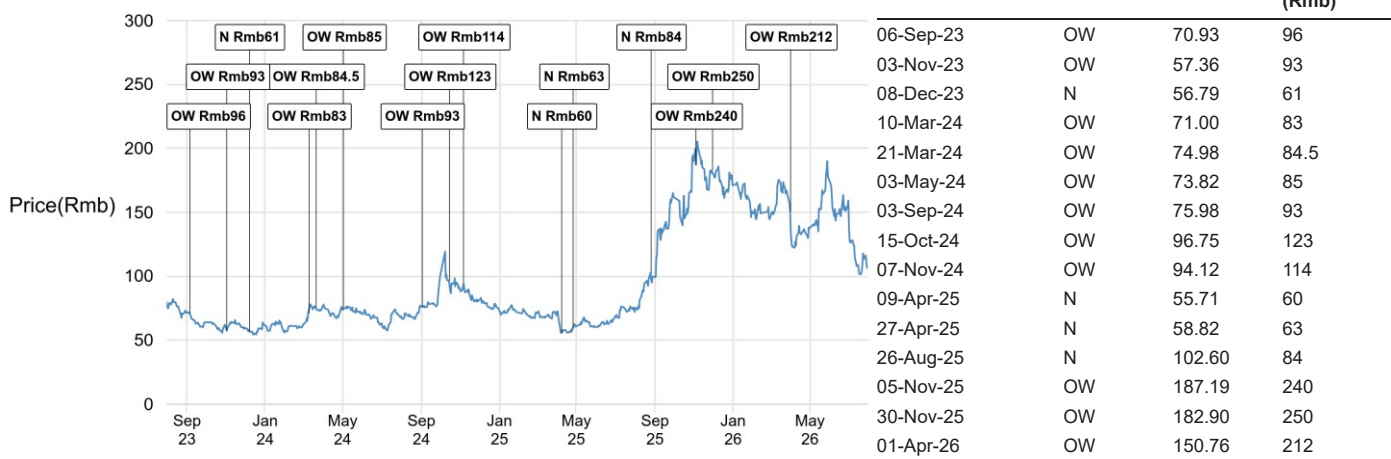
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Sungrow - A (300274.SZ, 300274 CH) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Jun 07, 2021. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Deye - A (605117.SS, 605117 CH) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (Rmb)	Price Target (Rmb)
14-May-26	OW	158.87	154

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
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